

Word family: **pretend / pretends / pretended / pretending / pretence / pretense / pretended**

Base word: pretend

Part of speech: mainly **verb**, also **adjective** in limited uses

Related forms:

* **pretend** (v.) — 假裝；佯裝；假稱

* **pretended** (adj.) — 假裝的；假稱的；不真實的

* **pretending** (n./gerund) — 假裝

* **pretence** (BrE) / **pretense** (AmE) (n.) — 假裝；藉口；假象

* **under the pretence/pretense of** — 以.....為名 / 藉口

* **make-believe** — 假裝遊戲；虛構的

* **pretend play** — 假裝遊戲；角色扮演式遊戲

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **pretend to do something**

* **pretend that...**

* **pretend to be**

* **pretend not to know**

* **pretend nothing happened**

* **pretend everything is fine**

* **pretend interest**

* **pretend ignorance**

* **pretence / pretense**

* **under the pretence of**

* **drop the pretence**

* **keep up the pretence**

* **pretend play**

Meaning in this passage

> Even now, I respect people more when they can own their mistakes instead of **pretending nothing happened**.

Here, **pretending nothing happened** means:

acting as if the mistake or incident did not happen, even though it did — 假裝甚麼都沒發生；裝作若無其事

The speaker respects people who acknowledge their mistakes rather than behaving as though there is nothing to address.

****中文翻譯：****

直到現在，我都會更加尊重那些願意承認錯誤、而不是****假裝甚麼都沒發生****的人。

So here:

**pretend = 明知真實情況不是這樣，卻故意表現得好像它是真的**

1. **pretend to do something — 假裝做某事**

A core pattern.

Practice 1

> He ****pretended to read**** while listening to our conversation.

他****假裝看書****，其實在聽我們說話。

Practice 2

> She ****pretended to sleep****.

她****假裝睡着了****。

Practice 3

> He ****pretended to understand**** the instructions.

他****假裝自己明白****那些指示。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****pretend to do X = 實際上沒有真正做 / 處於 X 狀態，卻故意表現得好像有****

2. **pretend that... — 假裝.....是真的**

Practice 1

> She ****pretended that she was fine****.

她****假裝自己沒事****。

Practice 2

> He **pretended** that nothing had happened.

他**假裝**甚麼都沒發生。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretend that... = 明知某個情況並非如此，卻故意表現得好像它是真的

3. **pretend to be** — 假裝是.....

Practice 1

> The child **pretended to be a doctor**.

孩子**假裝**自己是醫生。

Practice 2

> He **pretended to be confident**.

他**假裝**自己很有自信。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretend to be X = 表現得像自己是 X 或處於 X 狀態，但實際上不是

4. **pretend nothing happened** — 假裝甚麼都沒發生

This is the exact expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Some people **pretend nothing happened** instead of admitting their mistakes.

有些人不承認錯誤，反而**假裝**甚麼都沒發生。

Practice 2

> You can't just **pretend nothing happened** after hurting someone.

傷害了別人之後，你不能只是**裝作若無其事**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****pretend nothing happened = 明知事情已經發生，卻故意不承認或不處理，表現得像完全沒事****

5. ****pretend everything is fine — 假裝一切都沒問題****

Practice 1

> She smiled and ****pretended everything was fine****.

她笑着****假裝一切都沒事****。

Practice 2

> It's exhausting to ****pretend everything is fine**** when you're upset.

明明不開心卻要****裝作一切正常****，很令人疲累。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****pretend everything is fine = 即使實際有問題，仍表現得像完全沒事****

6. ****pretend not to know — 假裝不知道****

Practice 1

> He ****pretended not to know**** who had deleted the file.

他****假裝不知道****是誰刪了檔案。

Practice 2

> She ****pretended not to notice**** the mistake.

她****假裝沒有注意到****那個錯誤。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****pretend not to do/know X = 實際知道或察覺，但故意表現得像不知道 / 沒有察覺****

7. ****pretend not to care — 假裝不在乎****

Practice 1

> He **pretended not to care**, but I could tell he was upset.

他**假裝不在乎**，但我看得出他其實很不開心。

Practice 2

> She **pretended not to care** about the criticism.

她**裝作不在乎**那些批評。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretend not to care = 實際上在意，但故意表現得不在乎

8. **pretend interest** — 假裝有興趣

Practice 1

> He **pretended interest** in the conversation.

他**假裝對談話有興趣**。

Practice 2

> She smiled and **pretended to be interested**.

她笑着**裝作很有興趣**。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretend interest = 實際沒有興趣，但故意表現出有興趣的樣子

9. **pretend ignorance** — 假裝不知道

A more formal noun construction.

Practice 1

> He **pretended ignorance** when asked about the missing file.

有人問起失蹤的檔案時，他**假裝不知道**。

Practice 2

> She could no longer **pretend ignorance** of the problem.

她再也不能**裝作不知道這個問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretend ignorance = 明知某事，卻故意裝作不知道

10. **pretend** (兒童遊戲：扮演；假想) — 假裝；扮演

A neutral and often positive use.

Practice 1

> The children **pretended** to be astronauts.

孩子們**假裝**自己是太空人。

Practice 2

> Let's **pretend** this box is a spaceship.

我們**假裝**這個箱子是一艘太空船吧。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretend = 在遊戲或想像中假裝某個角色或情況是真的

11. **pretend play** — 假裝遊戲；角色扮演式遊戲

Practice 1

> **Pretend play** helps children use their imagination.

假裝遊戲 / 角色扮演遊戲有助兒童發揮想像力。

Practice 2

> The children engaged in **pretend play**.

孩子們正在進行**假想角色遊戲**。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretend play = 兒童透過假裝角色、物件或情境進行的想像遊戲

12. **pretend (假稱；冒充) — 假稱；冒充**

A more deceptive sense.

Practice 1

> He **pretended to be a police officer**.

他**冒充警員**。

Practice 2

> She **pretended to represent the company**.

她**假稱自己代表公司**。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretend to be X = 故意聲稱或表現成 X，尤其是在欺騙別人的情況下

13. **pretended (adjective：假裝的；虛假的) — 假的；裝出來的**

Practice 1

> He showed **pretended surprise**.

他表現出**裝出來的驚訝**。

Practice 2

> Her concern seemed **pretended** rather than sincere.

她的關心看來是**假裝的**，並不真誠。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretended = 表面看似真實，但其實是故意裝出來的

14. **pretence / pretense (假裝；虛假表現) — 假裝；假象**

Practice 1

> He dropped the **pretence** that everything was fine.

他不再**假裝**一切都沒問題。

Practice 2

> Her confidence was mostly a **pretence**.

她的自信大部分只是**裝出來的假象**。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretence/pretense = 故意營造的不真實外表或假裝狀態

15. **keep up the pretence** — 繼續裝下去；維持假象

Practice 1

> He couldn't **keep up the pretence** any longer.

他再也無法**繼續裝下去**。

Practice 2

> They **kept up the pretence** that nothing was wrong.

他們一直**維持一切正常的假象**。

MCQ-ready definition:

keep up the pretence = 持續維持某種明知不真實的表現或假象

16. **drop the pretence** — 不再假裝

Practice 1

> She finally **dropped the pretence** and admitted she was angry.

她終於**不再假裝**，承認自己很生氣。

Practice 2

> Let's **drop the pretence** that the plan is working.

不要再**假裝這個計劃行得通**了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****drop the pretence = 停止維持虛假的表面，開始承認真實情況****

17. ****under the pretence / pretense of — 以.....為藉口 / 名義****

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> He entered the office ****under the pretence of delivering a package****.

他以送包裹為****藉口****進入辦公室。

Practice 2

> She contacted him ****under the pretense of asking for advice****.

她以請教意見為****名義 / 藉口****聯絡他。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****under the pretence of X = 表面聲稱是為了 X，但實際上有另一個目的****

18. ****false pretence / false pretense — 虛假藉口；虛假陳述****

Practice 1

> He obtained the information under a ****false pretence****.

他以****虛假藉口****取得資料。

Practice 2

> They entered under ****false pretenses****.

他們以****虛假理由 / 身份****進入。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****false pretence/pretense = 為欺騙別人而提供的不真實理由、身份或表面說法****

19. **no pretence of — 毫不假裝；根本沒有聲稱.....**

A useful formal pattern.

Practice 1

> The book makes **no pretence of being objective**.

這本書**完全沒有假裝自己是客觀的**。

Practice 2

> He made **no pretence of liking the decision**.

他**完全沒有裝作喜歡這個決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

make no pretence of X = 坦白不裝作自己具備 / 感受到 X

20. **pretend (想像某種假設情況) — 假設；假想**

Especially common in teaching and hypothetical explanation.

Practice 1

> **Pretend** you are the manager. What would you do?

假設你是經理，你會怎樣做？

Practice 2

> Let's **pretend** the deadline is tomorrow.

我們**假設**截止日期是明天。

MCQ-ready definition:

pretend X is true = 暫時假想 X 是真的，以便遊戲、討論或推理

Important distinction 1: **pretend vs lie**

pretend

act as though something is true.

lie

state something false with intent to deceive.

You can pretend without saying anything false:

> pretend to be asleep

假裝睡覺

No spoken lie is necessary.

So:

pretend = 行為 / 表現上的假裝

lie = 說出自己知道是假的內容

Important distinction 2: **pretend vs fake**

pretend

verb focusing on acting as though something is true.

fake

can mean deliberately imitate, manufacture falsely, or pretend.

> pretend to smile

> 假裝微笑

> fake a signature

> 偽造簽名

****Fake**** often has a stronger deception/fraud nuance.

Important distinction 3: **pretend vs act**

act

can simply mean behave.

act as if / act like

can overlap with pretend.

> He acted as if nothing had happened.

他表現得像甚麼都沒發生。

This is very close to:

> He pretended nothing had happened.

But **pretend** more clearly signals that the appearance is knowingly false.

Important distinction 4: **pretend vs imagine**

pretend

act or speak as though something is true.

imagine

form a mental picture or possibility.

> Imagine you're in Paris.

想像你在巴黎。

> Pretend you're in Paris.

假裝你正在巴黎，並按這個角色 / 情況行事。

Important distinction 5: **pretend vs suppose**

suppose

assume something for reasoning.

pretend

more vivid, often involving acting or deliberate make-believe.

> Suppose the price doubles.

假設價格翻倍。

> Pretend you're the customer.

假裝你是顧客。

Important distinction 6: **pretend nothing happened vs ignore what happened**

pretend nothing happened

behave as though the event did not occur.

ignore what happened

know it occurred but choose not to respond.

They overlap, but **pretend** adds the element of maintaining a false appearance.

Important distinction 7: **pretend not to know vs genuinely not know**

Pretend:

you know, but hide it.

Genuinely not know:

you actually lack the information.

This difference is about **awareness + deliberate deception**.

Important distinction 8: **pretend to be vs impersonate**

pretend to be

broad; can be playful or deceptive.

impersonate

specifically act as another real person or role, often convincingly.

A child can pretend to be a doctor without impersonating any particular doctor.

Important distinction 9: **pretend play is not dishonest**

In children's play:

> pretend = 想像 / 角色扮演

There is no negative deception meaning.

Context completely changes the tone.

Important distinction 10: **pretence vs excuse**

pretence

false appearance or claimed reason.

excuse

reason given to justify behavior or avoid blame.

> under the pretence of helping

> 以「幫忙」為名，實際另有目的

> make an excuse for being late

> 為遲到找藉口

They can overlap, but they are not the same.

Important distinction 11: **pretence vs appearance**

appearance

how something seems; may be accidental.

pretence

deliberately created false appearance.

So **pretence** implies intention.

Important distinction 12: **pretended vs pretend**

pretended

adjective:

> pretended concern

裝出來的關心

pretend

verb:

> pretend to care

假裝在乎

Important distinction 13: **pretend vs deny**

deny

say something is not true.

pretend

behave as though something different is true.

For your passage:

> pretend nothing happened

does not necessarily mean verbally saying:

> “Nothing happened.”

It can simply mean acting normally and avoiding responsibility.

Important distinction 14: **pretend vs cover up**

pretend

maintain a false appearance.

cover up

actively hide evidence or facts, often more serious.

Kevin's hypothetical bad response would be **pretending nothing happened**, not necessarily a cover-up.

Important distinction 15: **pretend vs sugar-coat**

Relevant to this passage.

pretend

act as if reality is different.

sugar-coat

admit the basic reality but make it sound less bad.

Example:

> “Nothing happened.”

> = pretending / denial

> “It was just a tiny misunderstanding.”

> = possibly sugar-coating

Family-extension note

Pretend has one central semantic core:

behave as if something is true when you know or understand that it is not actually true

That branches into:

1. **deceptive/social pretending**

- * pretend nothing happened
- * pretend not to know
- * pretend to care

2. **role-playing / imagination**

- * pretend to be a doctor
- * pretend play

3. **hypothetical framing**

- * pretend you're the manager

4. **noun family**

- * pretence / pretense
- * keep up the pretence
- * under the pretence of

5. **adjective**

- * pretended concern
- * pretended surprise

For your passage, the important branch is:

deliberately acting as if the mistake did not happen, rather than acknowledging it

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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pretend to do X	假裝做 X	act as if	
pretend that...	假裝.....是真的	false appearance	
pretend to be X	假裝是 X	role/identity	
pretend nothing happened	假裝甚麼都沒發生	avoid acknowledging event	
pretend everything is fine	假裝一切正常	hide problem	

pretend not to know	假裝不知道	conceal knowledge	
pretend not to care	假裝不在乎	conceal emotion	
pretend interest	假裝有興趣	false interest	
pretend play	假裝遊戲	imaginative play	
pretend (hypothetical)	假設 / 假想	imagine for discussion	
pretended	裝出來的；假的	not genuine	
pretence/pretense	假裝；假象	false appearance	
keep up the pretence	繼續裝下去	maintain false appearance	
drop the pretence	不再假裝	stop pretending	
under the pretence of	以.....為藉口 / 名義	false stated reason	
false pretence	虛假藉口 / 虛假表現	deception	
make no pretence of	毫不假裝	openly not claiming	

For your original sentence

> Even now, I respect people more when they can own their mistakes instead of **pretending nothing happened**.

Here:

pretending nothing happened = 明知自己做錯、也明知對方受到影響，卻故意表現得像事情根本沒有發生一樣

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 直到現在，我都會更加尊重那些願意承認錯誤、而不是**假裝甚麼都沒發生**的人。

The contrast is especially strong:

> **own your mistakes**

> = 承認「這是我做錯的」，願意負責

> **pretend nothing happened**

> = 不承認、不處理，裝作若無其事

That makes **pretend** a very precise choice here.